1930s, the discourse of 'science' that was influencing the concept 'technology' was determined by the 'scientific management' rhetoric of Taylorism. This rhetoric, which we find in the 1930s version of the concept 'technology,' was tailored to conceal the fact that materialities contain socialities. The concept Karl Marx had tried because he thought it was promising had been developed into the concept Leo Marx has aptly called "hazardous."

22.5 Addendum: On Central and Peripheral Historiographical Issues

To add support to the call for research on the emergence and development of the concept 'technology' in the modern period, we may also consider the implications of the absence of such a concept before modernity. The realization that 'technology' did not exist as a concept before modernity invites us to question if there can be such a thing as a history of technology in antiquity or in any other pre-modern historical period, western or not. If the answer is yes, how do we produce meaningful analogies between modern technology and its historical counterpart in another period (whatever that may turn out to be)? In pursuit of such analogies, it seems to me that we need to revisit the answers to some of the foundational questions of historiography of technology. Consider, for example, the question posed in *Does Technology Drive History? The Dilemma of Technological Determinism*, which was edited by Leo Marx and Merritt Roe Smith (1994). Would it be meaningful to raise such a question in the context of the historiography of antiquity? And is there a dilemma about technological determinism in antiquity?[17]

In regards to modernity, the dilemma of technological determinism is a different manifestation of the ambiguity of the classic political economy that this chapter has argued about. It follows that the hazardousness of 'technology' has to do with the way the use of the concept allows for the hegemony of the ideology of technological determinism. Considering the correspondences between this concept and that of 'surplus value', technological determinism can be interpreted as the key ingredient of an ideology that the *Capital* introduced as the 'fetishism of commodities'. We saw how important to this ideology is the vulgar presentation by 'scientific management' of materialities as independent of socialities.

Having touched on the similarity between technological determinism and the ambiguity of classic political economy, I will conclude by registering one last note regarding the absence of the concept 'technology' before modernity. The concept 'technology' was not used, for example, in Greek antiquity or during the Byzantine period. It follows that those who profess to practice the history of technology in these periods have to be explicit about the concepts (if any) they consider to be

[17] A suggestive update on the persistence of technological determinism is given by Sally Wyatt (2008).